

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's look at different natural disasters!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about geography, climate and environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that have happened.
- I can skim a text for important information.

Ask your partner:

- If you could volunteer to help victims of natural disaster, what types of tasks would you do to help them?
- Do you think natural disasters are connected to the human impact on the environment? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Avalanches, earthquakes and hurricanes*— which is the worst?

* Of these three natural disasters, earthquakes have caused the most damage and destruction.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Avalanches, hurricanes, and earthquakes are just some of the ways that the earth reminds us who is in control. No matter how much we humans think we can control nature, nature always manages to surprise us. All my life, I've heard incredible stories about natural disasters.

Since I was a child, I've had a fascination with hurricanes, which are incredibly strong windstorms that usually start over the ocean and strike coastal cities. The winds are so strong that often homes are destroyed and people are injured or killed. The only protection against a hurricane may be to evacuate the area. A close friend of mine was in New Orleans in 2005 when Katrina hit. She was lucky to escape before being trapped by floods and has recently become a volunteer for a disaster relief organization because of her experience. It is also difficult to protect yourself against earthquakes, which are so dangerous that it is not uncommon for homes to collapse and bury people. Rescue teams in earthquake-prone areas rescue people and save lives, but their job is challenging. My uncle who moved to Nepal before the earthquake wreaked havoc there, rescued a few people from disaster. Of all the natural disasters I've heard about, it's avalanches that frighten me the most. Although avalanches are less common events, they still pose a serious threat to property and human lives. Avalanches are unforeseeable events which can throw a person down a mountain slope with no control.

For decades, my brother has snowboarded on mountain ranges around the world. He has recently been to the Rocky Mountains in British Columbia, Canada where he watched an avalanche roll down a mountain. His friend John, who was with him, was once trapped in an avalanche. Before he was buried, he remembered to cover his face with his arm to create an air pocket. Fortunately, because he did that he survived.

Natural disasters come from the sky, the sea or from inside the earth. No matter what the source, all natural disasters share power, strength and the potential to cause serious damage.



Let's Practice!

There are some words you can use any time you read or write down information, like in a blog.

Instructions: Find the words in the word search below.

- nobody
- never
- under
- yet
- whatever
- where



Let's Practice!

Have you ever been interested in events like hurricanes, earthquakes, avalanches or *landslides?

*A "landslide" is similar to an avalanche, but instead of snow, mud and rocks flow down a mountain slope.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct words in the given space to complete the sentence. Use capital letters where necessary.

- All my life, I has heared incredible stories about natural disasters. _____
- Since I was a child, I had has a fascination with hurricanes. _____
- My friend has become recently a volunteer for a disaster relief organization.

- For decades, my brother have snowboard on mountain ranges around the world.

- He recently has be to the Rocky Mountains. _____



Extension Activity

Find out 5 objects that could help you in an avalanche, an earthquake and a hurricane.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, come up with 5 objects that might help you survive each natural disaster.
- Make sure you explain the purpose or reason for the object in detail.
- Write a paragraph (100 to 150 words) about one of the natural disasters and explain how each object might help.
- Read your writing aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I explain which objects will help me survive and why.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about one natural disaster.

☐ ☐

I talk about 5 objects I have chosen for survival.

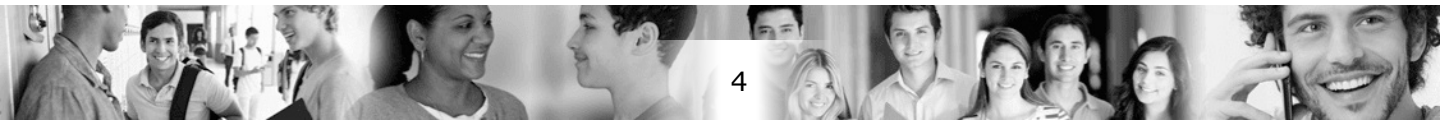
☐ ☐

I share my paragraph with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **avalanche** (noun): a large amount of ice, snow, dirt, or rock falling suddenly and quickly down the side of a mountain
e.g. Avalanches are unforeseeable events which can throw a person down a mountain slope with no control.
- **to strike** (verb): to hit
e.g. Hurricanes are incredibly strong windstorms that usually start over the ocean and strike coastal cities.
- **to trap** (verb): to be stuck in a bad or difficult situation
e.g. She was lucky to escape before being trapped by floods.
- **disaster relief organization** (noun): charitable group which provides medical, financial, and logistical help to areas affected by disasters
e.g. She has recently become a volunteer for a disaster relief organization because of her experience.
- **to pose a threat** (expression): to present a problem or danger
e.g. Avalanches pose a serious threat to property and human lives.
- **unforeseeable** (adjective): cannot be predicted
e.g. Avalanches are unforeseeable events which can throw a person down a mountain slope with no control.
- **air pocket** (noun): air filled space
e.g. Before he was buried, he remembered to cover his face with his arm to create an air pocket.
- **earthquake-prone** (adjective): likely to experience earthquakes
e.g. Rescue teams in earthquake-prone areas rescue people and save lives.
- **to wreak havoc** (verb): to cause damage and destruction
e.g. The earthquake wreaked havoc in Nepal.





Learning Points

Time Expressions with the Present Perfect

You can use time expressions with the Present Perfect or with the Past Simple. The Past Simple refers to completed, specific time like "yesterday" or "in 1973." Other time expressions may be used with either the Past Simple or the Present Perfect.

Time Expression	Use	Example
<i>for</i>	for a duration of time	<i>I have lived at this address for ten years.</i>
<i>never</i>	with negative sentences	<i>I have never been to Cuba.</i>
<i>before</i>	to describe something that happened at an unspecified time in the past	<i>I think I have seen her before.</i>
<i>all my life</i>	to describe something that was true and still is true	<i>I have had blonde hair all my life.</i>
<i>for a long time</i>	to describe something that was true and still is true	<i>I have worn these shoes for a long time.</i>
<i>today</i> <i>all day</i>	to describe something that has been true for the duration of the day	<i>I have drunk three cups of coffee today.</i> <i>I haven't seen my boss all day.</i>

Look at a few more examples from the text:

Examples:

- *All my life, I've heard incredible stories about natural disasters.*
- *She was lucky to escape before being trapped by floods and has recently become a volunteer for a disaster relief organization because of her experience.*
- *For decades, my brother has snowboarded on mountain ranges around the world.*

Reading Strategies

When you are reading, you don't need to understand every single word. You can just concentrate on the important words, and the others will be obvious based on the context of the text.





Learning Points

Generally, you need to be able to identify most of the shorter words in a text. These are usually the most important words.

Negative words, such as *neither*, *never* and *nobody*.

For example:

Nobody has ever climbed to the top.

Prepositions, such as *in*, *on*, *at* or *under*.

For example:

The mouse was hiding **under** the table.

Conjunctions, such as *for*, *nor*, *but* and *yet*.

For example:

He had eaten a great deal, **yet** he was still hungry.

And finally, **question words**, such as *who*, *what*, *when*, *which* and *where*.

Words from this final group can act as relative pronouns at the beginning of relative clauses.

For example:

My brother, **who** won the science award three years ago, built his own hot air balloon.

What I really want is to go to the park.

The chair **which** was broken has been taken to the dump.

We can do **whatever** he wants to do.

Take a look at a few examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Avalanches, hurricanes, and earthquakes are just some of the ways that the earth reminds us who is in control.*
- *Of all the natural disasters I've heard about, it's avalanches that frighten me most.*

